

Intermediate moves interrupt routine recaptures

Thinking And Training

THE IDEA

An intermediate move, or *zwischenzug*, creates a stronger immediate threat before making an expected recapture. Checks are common examples, but attacks on a queen or mate threats can also work. The original recapture must remain available or be replaced by a greater gain.

WORKED EXAMPLE

After your bishop is captured, you may have a checking rook move that forces the enemy king onto a fork square. Recapturing immediately would miss that opportunity. The check must not allow the opponent to save both targets.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you scan before any automatic recapture?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Checks, attacks on the queen, mating threats, and captures with tempo. Then compare their consequences with the straightforward recapture.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Treat recapture as a candidate rather than a reflex.